

AGP Acting Up

Q I have a P4 3.0 GHz, an Intel D865GBF motherboard, 512 MB of RAM and a Seagate 40 GB IDE hard drive. Recently, I purchased a Leadtek GeForce 6600 256 MB AGP card. My problem is that when I plug in the card and try to start my PC, it suddenly hangs (after loading XP), the monitor goes off, and the system restarts. The PC works properly with onboard graphics. I have a 350 W SMPS.

Arvind Sudevan

A First see if the cooling fan on your display adapter is working. Second, you could try completely uninstalling

any graphics drivers and then installing the latest drivers for your display adapter along with the latest version of DirectX for your version of Windows. But ideally, you should first plug in the display adapter and do a fresh install of Windows, then load DirectX and the latest display drivers. This way, only your display adapter's GART (Graphics Array Relocation Table) driver—which is necessary for full AGP functionality—will be loaded.

A 350 W SMPS is more than enough for the GeForce 6600 to function properly even at full load. If what we've mentioned doesn't get your card to work, your display adapter is probably faulty and needs replacement.

A Question Of Existence

Q I have an LG laptop with Windows XP Home Edition. I am unable to run the Group Policy Editor even though I log in as Administrator. How can I run GPEDIT.MSC?

James Thomas

A The Group Policy Editor is not available in Windows XP Home Edition, and therefore, the file GPEDIT.MSC doesn't exist on your installation.

Can Connect, Can't Chat

Q Our school computer connects to a server in the school for Internet access. While I am able surf freely, I am not able to connect to any messengers such as Yahoo!, MSN and Rediff. Why?

Shachi Dixit

A The PC probably accesses the Internet through a proxy server. It looks like the administrator has disabled the default ports that are used by messenger services, probably in accordance with the school's policy—meaning you aren't allowed to use Instant Messengers. You could try asking your administrator for access!

We Don't Help No Pirates!

Q My PC has Windows XP Pro with SP2. *Digit* distributed IE 7 Beta on a CD. When I tried to install it, I was unable to: I was taken to the Microsoft Web site to verify if my Windows was genuine. I've heard this check can be bypassed. Can you help me?

Pravin Mehra

A You can only install IE 7 if you have a legal version of XP. It appears you're using a pirated version. There may be ways to circumvent the check, but that amounts to piracy. We can't talk about any of these "workarounds."

Of Batteries And Software

Q I have a Celeron-M 1.5 GHz based HPn6110 laptop. It has a six-cell Li-ion battery. Is there any way to extend the battery life? I came across a battery-maximising software called "Battery Doubler" at www.dachshundsoftware.com. Battery Doubler has been discontinued; can you suggest a similar software?

Stanley Leo

Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details and complete system configuration to sos@jasubhai.com, and we might answer them here! Since we get many more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!

A Software can't manage anything but a few system tweaks. The best way to maximise battery life is to adopt a few good practices. In the Control Panel, launch Power Options, and set the power scheme to Portable/Laptop. You can also set a custom power scheme—for example, you could choose to switch off the hard disk after five minutes of inactivity. Remove any USB devices that are not being used. In addition, shut down Wi-Fi, Bluetooth and infrared.

Universal Serial Bug

Q I have a Panasonic NV-DS60 DV video camera with the IEEE 1394 4-pin connector. I purchased a USB 2.0 cable to connect the camera to my laptop. When I try to connect it, however, I get an error message: "One of the USB devices attached to this computer has malfunctioned, and Windows does not recognise it."

Prasanna Gonthi

A If you're using Windows 98, you will have to install the drivers for the camera for Windows to recognise it. If you're using XP, then for proper USB 2.0 functionality, you should install SP2. In addition, some DV video cameras require drivers to function in XP—most manufacturers provide these drivers along with the product. Also look for updated drivers on the Net.

The Heat Is On

Q While booting, the CPU temperature displayed in my BIOS is between 40 and 80°C. Can XP hang because of this? Second, my BenQ Combo drive is not able to write CD-RWs, nor read from them. I have Nero 6.6; in the Nero Info Tool, it says I don't have the drivers for my drive installed.

Deblina Naithani

A Your CPU is overheating, and XP might very well be hanging because of this. Possible causes can be the CPU fan not working, an improperly mounted heat sink, or an ill-ventilated cabinet. You might want to invest in a good heat-sink fan assembly.

The CD-Writer not being able to write CD-RWs is because it is old—this cannot be rectified. XP does not use the ASPI drivers that were used by previous versions of Windows to access the CD writing function. It uses a driver of its own—that's why Nero Info Tool reports the error. ■